

Xiaozhi (Taro) Yang

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EDUCATION & TRAINING

MindCORE Fellow, University of Pennsylvania 01/2025- present
Primary Advisors: Sudeep Bhatia, Joe Kable, Anna Schapiro

PennAI Fellow, University of Pennsylvania 08/2025- present

Visiting Graduate Researcher/Postdoctoral Researcher, UCLA 08/2023 – 12/2024

Ph.D., The Ohio State University 05/2024
Major: Psychology
Graduate Minor: Statistics, Department of Statistics
Committee members: Ian Krajbich (advisor), Duane Wegener, Roger Ratcliff

B.S., University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign 05/2019
Majors: Psychology & Statistics (double majors)
Honors thesis supervisor: Michel Regenwetter

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Judgment & Decision Making · Attention & Memory · Learning · Computational Modeling

WORKING PAPERS

Yang, X., Zhang, Z., Hsu, M., & Krajbich, I. A dynamic computational account of decisions with self-generated options. Revision submitted, *Science Advances*. [\[link\]](#), [\[data/code\]](#)

Yang, X., Zhao, W. J., Filipowicz, A., Zaneski, L., Caulfield, M. K., Plassmann, H., & Kable, J. Attribute-guided attention is an adaptive mechanism for efficient search during naturalistic decision-making. In review, *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*. [\[link\]](#), [\[data/code\]](#)

Fernandez, K., **Yang, X.**, Smith, S., Krajbich, I. Defending against AI agents with webcam eye tracking. Invited submission, *Communications Psychology*. [\[link\]](#)

Han, J., **Yang, X.**, Yuan, Y., Chen, F., & Camerer, C. Dynamic peer influence on honest participation and strategic misconduct in performance-based institutions. Working paper. [\[link\]](#)

PUBLICATIONS

Yang, X., & Bhatia, S. (in press) Dynamic attribute activation explains gaze biases in choice. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*. [\[link\]](#), [\[data/code\]](#)

Yang, X., Singh, D., Bhatia, S., & Schapiro, A. (2026) Interactions of hippocampal learning with prior knowledge. *Proceedings of Cognitive Computational Neuroscience Conference (Top 10% Spotlight poster)*. [\[link\]](#)

Yang, X., Riggs, E., Coronel, J., & Krajbich, I. (2026) Issue importance amplifies the effect of gaze on voting decisions. *Cognition*. [\[link\]](#), [\[data/code\]](#)

Krajbich, I., Fernandez, K., & **Yang, X.** (2024, September 6) Decomposing economic choices

with drift-diffusion models. *Book Chapter for Neuroeconomics: Core Topics and Current Directions*, Springer. [\[link\]](#)

Yang, X., Retzler, C., Ratcliff, R., Philiastides, M.G., & Krajbich, I. (2024) Attention to brand labels affects and is affected by evaluations of product attractiveness. *Frontiers in Behavioral Economics*. [\[link\]](#), [\[data/code\]](#)

Cavagnaro, D., **Yang, X.**, & Regenwetter, M. (2024) Choose for others as you would choose for yourself? A layered analysis of probabilistic preferential choice across social distance. *Journal of Economic Psychology*. [\[link\]](#), [\[data/code\]](#)

Yang, X. & Krajbich, I. (2023) A dynamic computational model of gaze and choice in multi-attribute decisions. *Psychological Review*. [\[link\]](#), [\[data/code\]](#)

Yang, X. & Krajbich, I. (2021) Webcam-based online eye-tracking for behavioral research. *Judgment and Decision Making*. [\[link\]](#), [\[open-source toolkit\]](#)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Snap, Inc	08.2022 – 02.2023
Research Intern, Computational Social Science team	Santa Monica, CA
Meta, Inc	05.2022 – 08.2022
Data Science Intern, AI Data Science, FAIR research	Menlo Park, CA

HONORS & AWARDS

PennAI Fellowship (\$16K), Philadelphia, PA	2025-2027
MindCORE Fellowship (3 years + \$20K research funds), Philadelphia, PA	2025-2028
Association for Consumer Research Conference Travel Award, Seattle, WA	2023
Neuroeconomics Summer School Travel Scholarship, Philadelphia, PA	2023
Herbert Toops Research Award, The Ohio State University	2023
CCBS Graduate Research Award, The Ohio State University	2023
Distinguished University Fellowship, The Ohio State University	2019 – 2020
Janet Tritsch Memorial Award, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign	2019
Highest Distinction, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign	2019
James Spoor Scholarship, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign	2018

RESEARCH GRANTS

Google Cloud Research Program, Google	2026-2027
Research Grant (\$6000, with \$1000 GenAI research credits)	
Proposal: The dynamics of querying process with language models	
Center for Socially Responsible AI, Penn State University	2026-2028
Research Grant (\$19680, Co-PI: Yuchen Yang, School of Information Science)	
Proposal: Persuasion-aware explanations for safer AI-mediated decisions [paper link]	
Decision Science Collaborative, The Ohio State University	2023-2024
Research Grant (\$3000)	
Proposal: The role of social perception in social learning	

CONFERENCE TALKS

<i>Society for Neuroeconomics</i> , Pasadena, CA	2026
<i>Consumer Neuroscience Satellite Symposium</i> , Pasadena, CA	2026
<i>Behavioral & Experimental Economics meeting</i> , State College, PA	2026
<i>Society for Mathematical Psychology</i> , Online	2026
<i>Philadelphia Decision Neuroscience Symposium</i> , Philadelphia, PA	2026
<i>Society for Judgment and Decision Making</i> , Denver, CO	2025
<i>Society for Neuroeconomics</i> , Boston, MA	2025
<i>Society for Judgment and Decision Making</i> , New York, NY	2024
<i>Association for Consumer Research</i> , Seattle, WA	2023
<i>Cognitive Development Society Conference</i> , Madison, WI	2022
<i>European Group of Process Tracing Annual Meeting</i> , Online	2021
<i>Society for Mathematical Psychology</i> , Online	2021

POSTER PRESENTATIONS

<i>Society for Judgment and Decision Making</i> , San Diego, CA	2026
<i>Psychonomic Society</i> , San Diego, CA	2026
<i>Society for Neuroeconomics</i> , Pasadena, CA	2026
<i>Cognitive Computational Neuroscience</i> , New York, NY	2026
<i>Society for Judgment and Decision Making</i> , Denver, CO	2025
<i>Society for Judgment and Decision Making</i> , San Francisco, CA	2023
<i>Interdisciplinary Symposium on Decision Neuroscience</i> , Philadelphia, PA	2023
<i>Society for Neuroeconomics</i> , Washington, DC	2022
<i>Decision Science Collaborative Spring Forum</i> , Columbus, OH	2022
<i>Interdisciplinary Symposium on Decision Neuroscience</i> , Online	2021
<i>Society for Neuroeconomics</i> , Online	2020, 2021
<i>Society for Mathematical Psychology</i> , Madison, WI	2018

INVITED TALKS

Decision Psychology Brownbag, The Ohio State University, OH, US	2026
Computational Neuroscience Initiative, University of Pennsylvania, PA, US	2026
Creativity lab (PI: Roger Beaty), Penn State University, PA, US	2025
Memory, Belief, and Choice Seminar, University of Pennsylvania, PA, US	2025
Social Psychology Group Meeting, University of Pennsylvania, PA, US	2025
MindCORE, University of Pennsylvania, PA, US	2024
Shenhav lab (PI: Amitai Shenhav), UC Berkeley, CA, US	2024
Neuroeconomics lab (PI: Ming Hsu), UC Berkeley, CA, US	2024
Department of Psychology, UCLA, CA, US	2024
School of Management, UCLA, CA, US	2023
School of Management, Zhejiang University, China	2023
Center for Comparative Psycholinguistics, University of Alberta, CA	2022

WORKSHOPS & EVENTS

Research tools discussion , Philadelphia, PA	2026
Role: <i>Panelist</i>	
Beyond Academia , Philadelphia, PA	2026
Role: <i>Panelist</i>	
Process Tracing Workshop , New York, NY	2024
Role: <i>Organizer/Presenter</i>	

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor

[PennAI Summer Hangouts Series](#), University of Pennsylvania, Summer, 2026

Guest lecturer

Computational models in decision making, University of Warwick, Spring, 2026

Introduction to Psychology (undergraduate level), The Ohio State University, Fall, 2021

Teaching Assistant

Introduction to Statistics, The Ohio State University, Spring, 2024

Decision Neuroscience and Neuroeconomics, The Ohio State University, Spring, 2023

Introduction to Cognitive Psychology, The Ohio State University, Spring, 2023

MENTORING EXPERIENCE

University of Pennsylvania

Adarsh Ramamurthy, Undergraduate, Department of Bioengineering

Project: *Interactions of category learning with prior knowledge in large language models (Poster presented at [MindCORE Summer Research Symposium 2026](#))*

Yiyang Zhang, Master's student, Department of Biotechnology

Project: *Efficient search in risky choice ([Poster](#) presented at SNE 2026)*

Hallie Li, Undergraduate, Department of Psychology

UCLA

Anthony Miceli, PhD student, Department of Psychology

Project: *Does across-trial variance in outcomes affect gaze and choice in risky decisions? ([Talk](#) presented at Math Psych 2026)*

Qingyang Wang, PhD student, UCLA Anderson

Project: *People neglect the opportunity for growth in resource allocation ([Poster](#) presented at SJDM 2025; received an honorable mention for best poster award)*

Evelyn Xu, Undergraduate, Department of Psychology

Ohio State

Jocelyn Xie, Undergraduate, Department of Psychology

Nicholas Kudlapur, Undergraduate, Department of Psychology

Nick McNeal, Undergraduate, Department of Computer Science

SERVICE

Journal Reviewer

Psychological Review

Nature Human Behaviour

Communications Psychology

Scientific Reports

Journal of Choice Modelling

Health Communication

Conference Reviewer

Cognitive Computational Neuroscience Conference

The International Conference for Computational Social Science

Proceedings of Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society

European Association of Consumer Research